# MODULE 12
# FINALE
# Fundraising & Final Presentations
# Your First 1000 Euros and Beyond

DELIVERABLE: 5-minute pitch + €1,000 verified revenue + your continuation decision

A joint initiative by

# CHECK-IN

What's your revenue number?

1. Total Revenue - What's your total earned so far?
2. Customer Count - How many paying customers?
3. Biggest Win - What are you most proud of?

Celebrate every win, big or small - you built something real!

# YOUR JOURNEY: From Idea to Revenue in 12 Weeks

Week 1-3: IDEATE - Found team, Validated problem

Week 4-6: BUILD - First prototype, First users

Week 7-9: VALIDATE - Killed assumptions, Found PMF signals

Week 10-12: MONETIZE - First revenue, Growth plan

The bar: €1,000 verified. The club: €10,000.

You didn't just learn theory - you built a real business with real customers

# Today

Check-in — final revenue numbers (10')

**IDEA 1 · Raise or don't (10')**

**IDEA 2 · The power law — how VCs think (15')**

**IDEA 3 · The pitch: proof + story (15')**

**IDEA 4 · After demo day — the company decides to live (15')**

Case · Celonis: raise from strength (30')

Workshop · Pitch Forge (95')

Wrap-up · Demo Day briefing (10')

# IDEA 1: Raise or don't

Default alive = leverage. Most great companies raised less — and later — than you think.

Grants, revenue-based financing and customers' money all exist. VC is a tool, not a trophy.

# The Fundraising Question

**Raise If**

**You need capital to capture a winner-take-all market, Speed is critical & you have PMF, You want to build a $1B+ company**

**Don't Raise If**

**Revenue can fund growth (most businesses!), You want control & optionality, You're not ready for 10x growth expectations**

"Default alive or default dead? If you're default alive, you have leverage. VCs need you more than you need them."

-- Paul Graham, Y Combinator

# The Funding Ladder

BOOTSTRAP ($0-100K): Your savings, revenue

F&F ($10-100K): Friends, family

ANGELS ($50-500K): Individual investors

SEED ($500K-2M): Pre-revenue or early PMF

SERIES A ($2-15M): PMF proven, scale time

Most successful startups raise less than you think.

Mailchimp never raised. Basecamp bootstrapped. Celonis was profitable for five YEARS before its first round.

# Alternatives to VC

BOOTSTRAPPING: Fund growth from revenue - Own 100%

Examples: Mailchimp ($12B exit), Basecamp, Zoho

GRANTS: Free money (non-dilutive) - Own 100%

EXIST, EIC, InnoEnergy, Horizon Europe

REVENUE-BASED: Pay back from revenue % - Own 100%

Pipe, Clearco, Capchase

ANGEL SYNDICATES: Smaller checks, less pressure - Own ~85%

AngelList, local angel groups

CROWDFUNDING: Community-funded - Own ~95%

Kickstarter, Republic, Seedrs

# IDEA 2: The power law

VCs need fund-returners, so they buy plausible $1B+ stories.

Know honestly whether you're telling one — and choose your capital accordingly.

# The Power Law

Why VCs think differently than you

A $100M fund invests in 20 companies. Most will fail. 1-2 must return the ENTIRE fund (10-100x).

Typical VC Portfolio of 20 Investments:

10 fail (0x) | 7 return 1-3x | 2 return 10-50x | 1 unicorn (100x+)

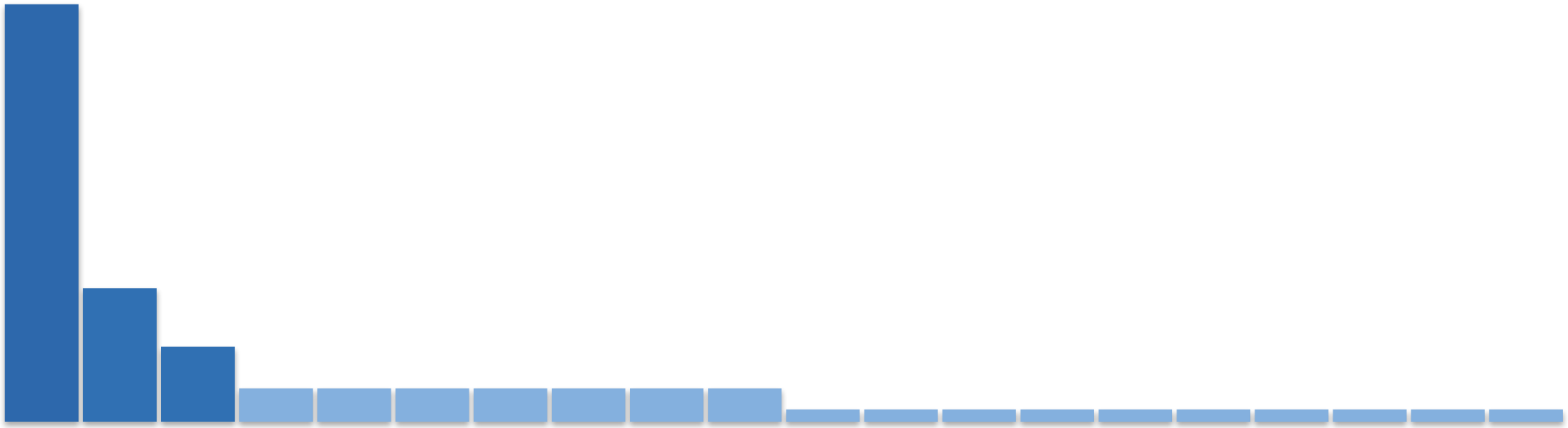
What This Means For You: VCs only invest in companies that could plausibly become $1B+.

If your goal is a $10M lifestyle business, don't raise VC — it's the wrong tool.

# The power law, drawn to scale

One investment returns the fund. Two or three return capital. The rest… don't.

**This is not pessimism — it's the arithmetic your investor lives with.**



a 20-company VC portfolio, returns drawn to scale — #1 pays for everything

# What the evidence says

Venture returns follow a power law — a handful of outliers pays for everything else (Kerr, Nanda & Rhodes-Kropf 2014, Journal of Economic Perspectives).

That is WHY VCs need a plausible $1B+ story: the model breaks on modest wins.

**Your job today is not to promise a unicorn. It's to know honestly whether you're telling that kind of story — and to choose your capital accordingly.**

Raising from strength beats raising from need — five bootstrapped years bought Celonis its terms (today's case).

# What Investors Actually Look For

**TEAM**

**Can YOU build this? Domain expertise, Complementary skills, Track record, Resilience & grit**

**MARKET**

**Is it WORTH building? $1B+ total market, Growing 20%+, Clear tailwinds, Winner-take-all, Timing right**

**TRACTION**

**Is it WORKING? Revenue (best proof), User growth curve, Engagement metrics, NPS/retention, Pipeline**

# Term Sheet Essentials

**Pre-Money Valuation**
**Company value BEFORE investment - Higher = less dilution**

**Post-Money Valuation**

**What you're worth after - Pre-money + investment amount**

**Dilution**

**% of ownership you give up - Seed: typically 15-25%**

**Liquidation Preference**

**Who gets paid first in exit - 1x non-participating = fair**

**Pro-Rata Rights**

**Right to maintain ownership % - Investors want this**

**Board Seats**

**Who controls key decisions - Keep founder majority**

"Always get a startup lawyer. YC's SAFE and NVCA docs are founder-friendly starting points."

-- Fundraising Wisdom

# IDEA 3: The pitch: proof + story

Sequoia's ten slides. Five minutes. One big number per slide.

Plan the raise like a sales funnel — because it is one.

# The Sequoia Pitch Deck

10 slides that tell your story

1. PURPOSE - Why does your company exist? (1 sentence)
2. PROBLEM - What pain are you solving? (Be specific)
3. SOLUTION - How do you solve it? (Demo > words)
4. WHY NOW - Why is this moment right? (Market timing)
5. MARKET - How big is the opportunity? (TAM/SAM/SOM)
6. COMPETITION - Who else is solving this? (Be honest)
7. PRODUCT - What have you built? (Show, don't tell)
8. TRACTION - What proves it works? (Revenue, users)
9. TEAM - Why you? (Unfair advantage)
10. ASK - What do you need? (Specific amount)

# Your 5-Minute Pitch

The structure that works:

0:00-0:30 HOOK - Start with a story or shocking stat

0:30-1:30 PROBLEM - Make them feel the pain

1:30-2:30 SOLUTION - Demo > slides > talking

2:30-3:30 TRACTION - Numbers that prove it works

3:30-4:30 TEAM & WHY - Why you'll win

4:30-5:00 ASK - Specific amount and use of funds

# Golden Rules for Pitching

Practice until you can do it without slides

One big number per slide

End with energy, not a whimper

# The 10x Rule for Fundraising

Evidence-based approach to investor meetings:

100 → 30-40 → 5-10 → 1-2

investors to contact → meetings you'll get → term sheets possible → deals you'll close

Treat the raise like a sales funnel: track every contact in a CRM

(the funnel numbers above are practitioner heuristics, not laws).

Each rejection teaches you something — embrace the feedback.

Your Action Plan:

1. Build list of 100 relevant investors
2. Warm intros > cold outreach (3x response rate)
3. Track everything in a CRM

# IDEA 4: After demo day

The course ends. The company decides not to.

GPK on the company · a signed 90-day plan · IP and money settled · one meeting booked.

# Demo Day: how it works

5-minute pitch + Q&A. Judges score four things: problem evidence · verified traction · decision quality · clarity.

**Revenue verification: payment dashboard or invoices, outside your social graph only. Screenshots prepared BEFORE demo day.**

An honest, evidence-backed kill presents on demo day too — and can outscore a zombie 'success'.

Format varies by university — the full run-of-show lives with your instructor (Demo Day Pack).

# After demo day: the real decision

**The course ends. The company doesn't have to. This week your team decides: GO / PIVOT / KILL — on the company, not the pitch.**

Run the GPK framework one last time, on the whole semester's evidence pack.

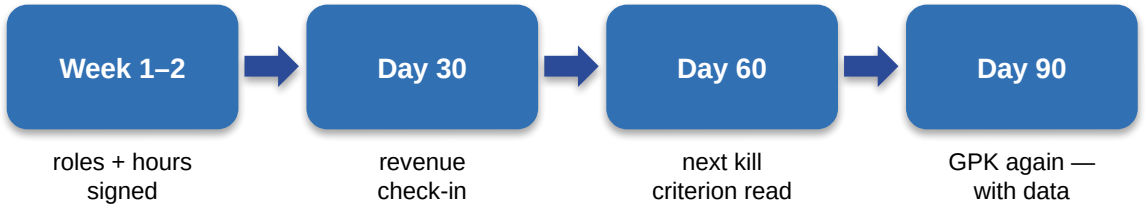
A well-argued kill with documented evidence is an A-grade outcome. A zombie project is not.

# If you continue: the 90-day plan

Who works on what · hours per week per founder · the next revenue target · the next kill criterion.

**All founders sign it. This week — commitment decays fast once exams start.**

Book the first check-in before you leave the room. A calendar entry, not an intention.



# The unsexy questions — settle them now

Who owns the IP — code, brand, data? Write it down, even among friends. Especially among friends.

Who owns the money you made? Your GbR needs a written split agreement (Module 9, remember the liability).

UG/GmbH: found when liability, IP pooling, or investors demand it — not before, and not after.

**One hour of startup legal office hours saves one friendship. Book it.**

# Your launchpad: what happens Monday

TUM Venture Labs: office hours, programs, network — your evidence pack is the application.

EXIST founder scholarship: ~12 months of runway for exactly teams like you. Celonis started on it, with €12,500 and a TUM lab.

XPLORE, incubators, angels, YC/EF — traction beats essays everywhere.

**Leave today with ONE booked meeting. That's the whole assignment.**

# END RECAP — today in one breath

1 · Default alive is leverage — raise from strength or not at all

2 · The power law explains every VC 'no' you'll ever get

3 · Five minutes, ten slides, one number per slide

4 · GPK the company, sign the 90-day plan, book the meeting

**Demo Day: €1,000 verified minimum. The €10,000 club is open.**

# Workshop: Pitch Forge (90 min)

Agenda lives in M12_Workshop_Pitch-Forge.md. You arrive with pitch draft v1 — that was Module 11 homework.

**Must produce: a polished 5-minute pitch, pressure-tested in two practice rounds.**

Kill criteria: you're still explaining the product at minute 3 — start over from the problem.

# Celebrating Your Journey

From idea to revenue in 12 weeks

- ✓ Validated a real problem
- ✓ Built with AI tools
- ✓ Found real users
- ✓ Generated real revenue
- ✓ Learned to iterate fast

You didn't just learn entrepreneurship — you DID entrepreneurship.

Now go build something amazing.

# Thank You!

A joint initiative by

# APPENDIX — original slides (3 restored as images)

These pages from the pre-rework deck are not in the current flow. Source snapshot: Instructor/original-decks/M12_Lecture_ORIGINAL.pdf.

**Mark each: KEEP (design pass rebuilds it properly, editable) or KILL. Nothing gets deleted without your call.**

# FINAL WORKSHOP: Pitch Preparation & Presentation Practice (90 min)

15 min: Story Crafting - Structure your pitch: Problem → Solution → Traction → Ask

20 min: Slide Polish - Finalize 5-7 slides that tell your story visually

5 min: Pitch Each - Each team delivers 5-min pitch to small group

10 min: Feedback - Peer feedback using 'What worked / What to improve'

40 min: Iterate - Incorporate feedback, practice 2 more times

Deliverable: Pitch-ready presentation

# The P.I.T.C.H. Framework

PROBLEM: Pain worth solving

INSIGHT: Why you win

TRACTION: Proof it works

CUSTOMER: Who pays and why

HOOK: Why now, why you

Congratulations! You've completed the journey from idea to revenue.

Now go build something amazing!

# Thank You!

A joint initiative by